

CITY HOSPITAL - MEDICATION ERROR REPORT

Incident Summary

Report Date: 2025-08-18

Report Number: MER-2025-0342

Reported By: James O'Malley, PharmD, Director of Pharmacy

Date of Error: 2025-08-17

Time Discovered: 14:45

Location: Pharmacy Department, Station 2

Patient Information

Name: Jane Smith (pseudonym)

DOB: 05/22/1975

MRN: SYN-789012

Room: 412B

Attending: Dr. Williams

Error Details

Error Type: Wrong dose dispensed

Medication: Warfarin

Prescribed Dose: 2.5mg

Dispensed Dose: 5.0mg

Route: Oral

Contributing Factors

1. Look-alike packaging (2.5mg and 5mg stored adjacent)
2. Barcode scanner malfunction (out of service for 3 hours)
3. Pharmacist staffing: 1 pharmacist covering 2 stations
4. High workload: 47 prescriptions pending

Error Detection

Detected By: Patricia Lee, RN

Detection Method: Independent double-check at bedside

Time to Detection: After 1 dose administered

Patient Impact

- One dose of 5mg warfarin administered (intended: 2.5mg)
- INR checked: 3.2 (therapeutic range 2.0-3.0)
- No bleeding events
- Vitamin K 2.5mg PO administered prophylactically
- Patient monitored for 24 hours

Corrective Actions

Action | Responsible | Due Date | Status

Replace barcode scanner | Biomed Engineering | 08/18 | Complete

Separate warfarin strengths | Pharmacy Manager | 08/19 | Complete

Staff retraining on LASA | Education Dept | 08/25 | In Progress

Independent double-check | Pharmacy Director | 08/30 | Planned

Review staffing model | Operations Manager | 09/15 | Planned